

married, you're married. Please tell Bill to call me when he comes in. We would like for you both to come down for a day as soon as you can."

"We will, I promise," Andrea replied. "And we're very happy, Mrs. Yates. We do love each other, and we didn't do this to hurt anyone."

"Andrea, you're a member of our family now, and we love you too. But you both need to learn that God wants us to be honest about everything. I'm disappointed that you didn't trust us enough to let us in on your decision. You can't start a relationship with an attitude of distrust. Please remember that in your marriage too."

When they hung up Andrea sat still for several minutes. What Bill's mother had said hit her in a sensitive spot. She knew they had been deceitful to their parents, and she knew she had been deceiving Bill. It had gone on so long now she was wondering how he would react when he finally knew the whole truth. When Bill came home, she told him about his mother's call. He looked like he was going to be sick for a minute. Then he said, "I don't blame her for being hurt and angry. I know I've been lying to them since we got married. I'd better call her and at least let her know I'm sorry."

"I'm sorry, Bill," Andrea said honestly. "I suppose I'm the one at fault. You wanted to call her, and I talked you out of it. I was afraid she would convince you not to get married."

"No, Andrea, I'm the one at fault. I know I'm supposed to be responsible. If I had had the courage, I would have been honest with my parents up front. I just hope this doesn't affect our relationship with them from now on."

After a brief conversation with his mother and his father, Bill hung up the phone. "Well, they're both hurt," he said. "But they want you to know that they're glad to have you as a member of our family, and they've accepted the situation. My dad said that we'll have to come up with the money for grad school ourselves. He believes we should stand on our own two feet. I guess that means I'll have to put it off for a while—at least until we can save a little money."